

AT ITS PEAK, THE MONGOL EMPIRE RULED OVER 100 MILLION PEOPLE

Mongol Empire

1206–1368

Founded by Genghis Khan in 1206. Numerous violent conquests led to the largest continuous land empire in history.



Mongol horde helmet

Mongol Empire in 1227 CE

Karakorum

Ming China in 1500 CE

Beijing

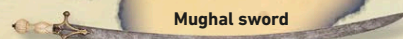
Ming China

1368–1644

Founded by Zhu Yuanzhang, the leader of an uprising that overthrew the Mongols. A socially stable era during which the Grand Canal and the Great Wall were rebuilt.

Mughal Empire in 1690 CE

Shahjahanabad (Old Delhi)



Mughal sword

Angkor

Khmer Empire in 900 CE



Holy Roman Empire

962–1806

One of the longest-lasting empires in history, this was a Christian state with no capital. In 1356 Frankfurt became the home of imperial elections.



Byzantine Empire

330–1453

Evolved from the Eastern Roman Empire. A Christian, Greek-speaking empire that preserved both Roman and Greek cultures.



Byzantine necklace pendant



Mughal Empire

1526–1857

The Mughals brought centralized government, education, and religious tolerance to south Asia.



Khmer Empire

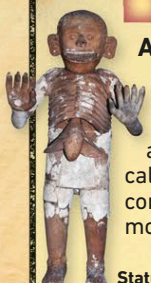
802–1400s

A Hindu and Buddhist empire influenced by Indian culture. Architecture of the empire reached its height with the construction of the temple at the capital, Angkor.

Aztec Empire

1428–1521

From their capital built on artificial islands on a lake, the Aztecs, who called themselves Mexica, conquered most of modern-day Mexico.



Statue of Aztec god of death

Chimú culture

c.850–1470

Skilled in pottery, textiles, and metalwork. Territory covered coastal regions by the Andes mountains. Conquered by the rival Inca Empire in 1470.

Inca Empire

1438–1536

The largest empire of pre-Spanish Americas. Incas worshipped Inti, the sun-god, and were skilled at building cities high up in the Andes mountains.



Songhai coin

Songhai Empire

1375–1591

Rose up in the wake of the declining Mali Empire. The city of Timbuktu became a center of Islamic learning.

Kanem Empire

700–1387

One of the most powerful African empires. The main religion became Islam during the second dynasty under the rule of the Sayfawa.

Ottoman Empire

1299–1922

Sometimes called the "Turkish Empire," a long-lasting Islamic state with the wealthy city of Constantinople (modern-day Istanbul) as its capital.

Umayyad Caliphate

661–1031

The second of four great Muslim dynasties of the Arab caliphate, meaning "kingdom."

Tihuanaco Empire

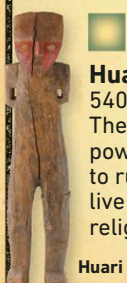
400–950

Began as a small town on the shores of Lake Titicaca on the border of Peru and Bolivia before rapidly expanding to the surrounding areas.

Huari Empire

540–1100

The first of the New World powers to use large cities to run the empire and to live in, rather than just for religious ceremonies.



Huari wooden figure